HMGT 327 · FUNDAMENTALS OF PROJECT MANAGEMENT

Conflict Management

Assignment 2 · Summary Sheet · Academic Year 1448 H (2026–2027 G), Fall 2026

STUDENT	ID NO.	FACILITATOR	SUBMITTED
Bassam K. Altayran	4411839	Dr. Elhussein Ibrahim	Saturday, 17.10.2026

1 Definitions

Conflict
A process that begins when one party perceives that another has negatively affected, or is about to affect, something it cares about (Robbins & Judge, 2019).

Conflict Management
Identifying and handling conflict fairly and efficiently to reduce its negative effects and increase its positive ones, such as new ideas and better decisions (Rahim, 2002).

2 Sources of Conflict in Hospitality Projects (Thamhain & Wilemon, 1975)

01 Schedules
Finishing before the Hajj, Umrah or Ramadan peak

02 Priorities
Closing floors vs. keeping rooms selling

03 Human resources
Staff shared between operations and the project

04 Technical opinions
Design and brand standards: owner vs. operator

05 Procedures
Unclear roles: owner, management company, contractors

06 Cost
FF&E overruns; who pays for changes

07 Personality & culture
Multicultural teams, different communication styles

+ Also
Poor communication and 24/7 guest-service pressure

3 Types of Conflict

By level
Intrapersonal · Interpersonal · Intragroup · Intergroup (e.g., housekeeping vs. project team) · Inter-organizational (hotel vs. contractor)

By content (Jehn, 1997)
Task the work and its goals · **Relationship** personal and emotional issues · **Process** who does what, and how

By effect
Functional new ideas, better decisions · **Dysfunctional** harms the team and delays the project

4 Conflict Analysis

1. **Parties:** who is involved and affected?
2. **Issue:** separate positions from real interests
3. **Root cause:** use the "5 Whys"
4. **Impact:** scope, time, cost, quality, guests
5. **Style:** choose the best-fit approach
6. **Monitor:** follow up and record lessons

Pondy (1967): Latent · Perceived · Felt · Manifest · Aftermath

5 Conflict Resolution Styles (Thomas & Kilmann, 1974)



PMBOK terms: force/direct · collaborate/problem-solve · compromise/reconcile · withdraw/avoid · smooth/accommodate (PMI, 2017)

Key sources: Robbins & Judge (2019) · Rahim (2002) · Thamhain & Wilemon (1975) · Jehn (1997) · Pondy (1967) · Thomas & Kilmann (1974) · PMI (2017) · Larson & Gray (2021) · Kerzner (2022)